was no other political programme before the country. The no-changers laid stress on a 'constructive programme', which in effect was a programme of social reform, and its chief merit was that it brought our workers in touch with the masses. This was not likely to satisfy those who believed in political action, and it was inevitable that after a wave of direct action, which had not succeeded, there should be a phase of parliamentary activity. Even this activity was envisaged by Deshbandhu Das and my father, the leaders of the new movement, as one of obstruction and defiance and not of co-operation and construction.

Mr. C. R. Das had always favoured entry into the legislatures for the purpose of carrying on the national struggle there also. My father had more or less the same outlook, his acceptance of the Council boycott in 1920 was partly a subordination of his own view-point to Gandhiji's. He wanted to throw his full weight into the struggle, and the only way to do it then was to accept the Gandhi formula *in toto*. The minds of many of the younger people were full of the tactics of Sinn Fein in so far as they had captured the parliamentary seats and then refused to enter the House of Commons. I remember pressing Gandhiji in the summer of 1920 to adopt this variant of the boycott, but in such matters he was adamant. Mohamad Ali was in Europe then on a Khilafat deputation. On his return he also expressed his regret at the method of boycott adopted; he would have preferred the Sinn Fein way. But it was quite immaterial what other individuals thought in the matter, as ultimately Gandhiji's view was bound to prevail. He was the author of the movement, and it was felt that he must be given freedom as to the details. His chief objections to the Sinn Fein method were (apart from its association with violence) that it would not be understood by the masses as much as a straight call to boycott the polling-booths and the voting. To get elected and then not to go to the Councils would create confusion in the mass mind. Further, that once our people got elected they would be drawn towards the Councils and it would be difficult for them to keep out of them. There was not enough discipline and power in our movement to keep them out for long, and a demoralising dribble would set in towards the many direct and indirect ways of taking advantage of Government patronage through the Councils.

These were weighty arguments and, indeed, we saw many of them justified in the middle 'twenties when the Swaraj Party went into the Councils. And yet one cannot help wondering what would have happened if the Congress had set itself to